

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 310

By Atchley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Carl Dean.

WHEREAS, it was with great sadness that the members of this General Assembly learned of the passing of Carl Dean, husband, partner, and biggest supporter of his wife, Dolly Parton, for sixty years; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Dean was a private man who eschewed the limelight of the music industry to focus on real estate dealings and attending to the couple's Nashville ranch; and

WHEREAS, although he shied away from the red carpet and show business functions, Mr. Dean deeply loved and respected Dolly Parton, and his unwavering support was instrumental in her perseverance in the music industry and her successful career as an artist and icon; and

WHEREAS, Carl Dean also served as an inspiration for Dolly Parton's songwriting; according to rumor, "Jolene," one of her signature songs, is partly based on a bank teller who flirted with her husband; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Dean was also the inspiration behind other songs written by his wife, including "From Here to the Moon and Back," "Forever Love," "Say Forever You'll Be Mine," and "Tomorrow is Forever," and he was featured on the cover of her album *My Blue Ridge Mountain Boy*; and

WHEREAS, to honor his never-ending love and support of his wife and her career, a special section has been dedicated to Carl Dean at the Dolly Parton Experience museum at Dollywood; and

WHEREAS, in 2016, Carl Dean and Dolly Parton renewed their marriage vows in celebration of their fiftieth wedding anniversary, proving that "if they had it to do all over again, they'd do it all over again"; and

WHEREAS, the couple first met at a laundromat in 1964 on the very first day Dolly Parton moved to Nashville to pursue a career in country music; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Dean and Miss Parton began dating, but soon thereafter, he enlisted in the National Guard and served two years during the Vietnam era; and

WHEREAS, in order to avoid publicity, they were secretly wed in 1966, and it was then that their magical journey through life together began; and

WHEREAS, a Nashville native, Mr. Dean was the son of the late Edgar "Ed" Henry Dean and the late Virginia "Ginny" Bates Dean; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his wife, Mr. Dean is survived by siblings, Sandra and Donnie; and

WHEREAS, upon his passing, Dolly Parton poignantly said: "Carl and I spent so many wonderful years together. Words cannot do justice to the love we shared for over sixty years"; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Carl Dean, reflecting fondly upon the purposeful life of "a good husband and a good man."

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and extend our condolences to Dolly Parton and Mr. Dean's family and friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.